

American Historical and Literary Curiosities, Part 20

J. Jay Smith

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*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK AMERICAN
HISTORICAL AND LITERARY CURIOSITIES, PART 20 ***

**AMERICAN HISTORICAL CURIOSITIES, Part
20.**

**AMERICAN HISTORICAL
AND
LITERARY CURIOSITIES**

By John Jay Smith

Part 20.

Second Series

1860

AMERICAN
Historical and Literary Curiosities;
CONSISTING OF
Fac-Similes of some Plates, &c. Relating to
COLUMBUS,
AND
ORIGINAL DOCUMENTS of the REVOLUTION,
&c. &c.

WITH A VARIETY OF RELIQUES, ANTIQUITIES, AND AUTOGRAPHS.

EDITED AND ARRANGED,
WITH THE ASSISTANCE OF SEVERAL AUTOGRAPH COLLECTORS,

BY

JOHN JAY SMITH,
MEMBER OF THE HISTORICAL SOCIETY OF PENNSYLVANIA, ETC.

SECOND SERIES—COMPLETE IN ITSELF.

NEW YORK:
CHARLES B. RICHARDSON.
1860.

Enlarge

P R E F A C E.

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Original Volume 2, Part Nine

CONTENTS.—No. IX.

PLATES LV. TO LVII.

PLATE LV.—“The Star Spangled Banner,” in fac-simile of the handwriting of the author, Francis S. Key; dated Washington, October 21, 1840. *In possession of Lewis J. Cist.*

PLATE LVI.—1. “Home, Sweet Home,” in fac-simile of the handwriting of the author, John Howard Payne; dated Washington City, September 13, 1841. *In possession of the same.*

2. Touching Note from Dr. E. K. Kane to his friend the publisher, Mr. George W. Childs, in which he remarks of his last volume, “The book, poor as it is, has been my coffin.” *In possession of Ferdinand J. Dreer.*

PLATE LVII.—General Washington’s Gold Watch and Seal, &c., bequeathed to Judge Bushrod Washington during his life, and, after his death, to Bushrod W. Adams, of Philadelphia, *in whose possession it now is carefully preserved.*

2. A Page of General Washington’s Weather Diary. This leaf *in possession of Ferdinand J. Dreer.* The remainder *in possession of Bushrod W. Adams, Philadelphia.*

3. Invitation from General Washington, addressed “Lieutenant Gookin, 2d N. Hamp.,” to dine. The artist has omitted the words on the little scrap of paper enclosed, viz., the “Parole, Alexandria,” and the countersigns “Bedford, and Colchester.” *In possession of J. Wingate Thornton, Boston,* who remarks that the smallness and inferiority of the paper both of the invitation and the enclosure, speak of the gloomiest period of the Revolution. No date, except November 17. Lieutenant Gookin was a distinguished officer, related to Mr. Thornton.

4. Singular Autograph Signature of Tobias Lear, Secretary of General Washington, and long a member of his family. *In possession of Ferdinand J. Dreer.*

5. Robert Morris’s Card, inviting the Honble. Mr. Jenifer to dine, 1781. This card shows the inferior style of issuing such invitations at that early date of our history. *In possession of Ferdinand J. Dreer.*

[Plate 55.](#)

[Plate 56.](#)

[Plate 57.](#)

The Star-spangled banner.

O! say, can ye see by the dawn's early light,
 What so proudly we hail'd by the twilight's last gleaming?
 Whose bright stars & broad stripes, through the clouds of the fight,
 O'er the ramparts we watch'd were so gallantly streaming?
 And the rocket's red glare - the bomb bursting in air,
 Gave proof through the night that our flag was still there
 O! say does that Star-spangled banner yet wave
 O'er the land of the free & the home of the brave?

On that shore, dimly seen through the mists of the deep,
 Where the foe's haughty host in dread silence reposes,
 What is that which the breeze, o'er the towering steep,
 As it fitfully blows, half-conceals, half-discloses?
 Now it catches the gleam of the morning's first beam,
 In full glory reflected, now shines on the stream.
 'Tis the Star-spangled banner - O! long may it wave
 O'er the land of the free & the home of the brave

And where is that host, that so vauntingly swore
 That the havoc of war & the battle's confusion
 A home & a country should leave us no more?
 Their blood has wash'd out their foul footsteps' pollution
 No refuge could save the hireling & glave
 From the terror of flight or the gloom of the grave
 And the star-spangled banner in triumph doth wave
 O'er the land of the free & the home of the brave.

O! thus be it ever when freemen shall stand
 Between their lov'd homes & the war's desolation
 Blest with vict'ry & peace, may the heav'n rescued land
 Praise the power that hath made & preserved us a nation
 Then conquer we must - when our cause it is just,
 And this be our motto - In God is our trust -
 And the star-spangled banner in triumph shall wave
 O'er the land of the free and the home of the brave.

Washington
 Oct 21 1840

T. J. Key

Enlarge

Home, Sweet Home!

Pl. LVI

'Mid pleasures and palaces though we may roam,
Be it ever so humble, there's no place like Home,
A charm from the sky, seems to hallow us there
Which, seek through the world, is ne'er met with elsewhere!

Home, home! Sweet, sweet Home!
There's no place like Home!
There's no place like Home!

11.

An exile from Home, splendour dazzles in vain!
Oh, give me my lowly thatch'd cottage again!
The birds singing gaily, that came at my call—
Give me them — with the peace of mind dearer than all!

Home, home! Sweet, sweet Home!
There's no place like Home!
There's no place like Home!

John Howard Payne.

Washington City, Sept. 13. 1841.

My dear Sir,

* * * * *

At present however
I see no possible chance
of being able to work
in any way, and the
unpleasant letters
that crowd around
me must well speak
an able man.

I leave in
a fortnight probably,
for Europe as the
sort of last resource
to catch my last
breath. The book
poor as it is - has
been my coffin

M^r. Formell's
house is at present

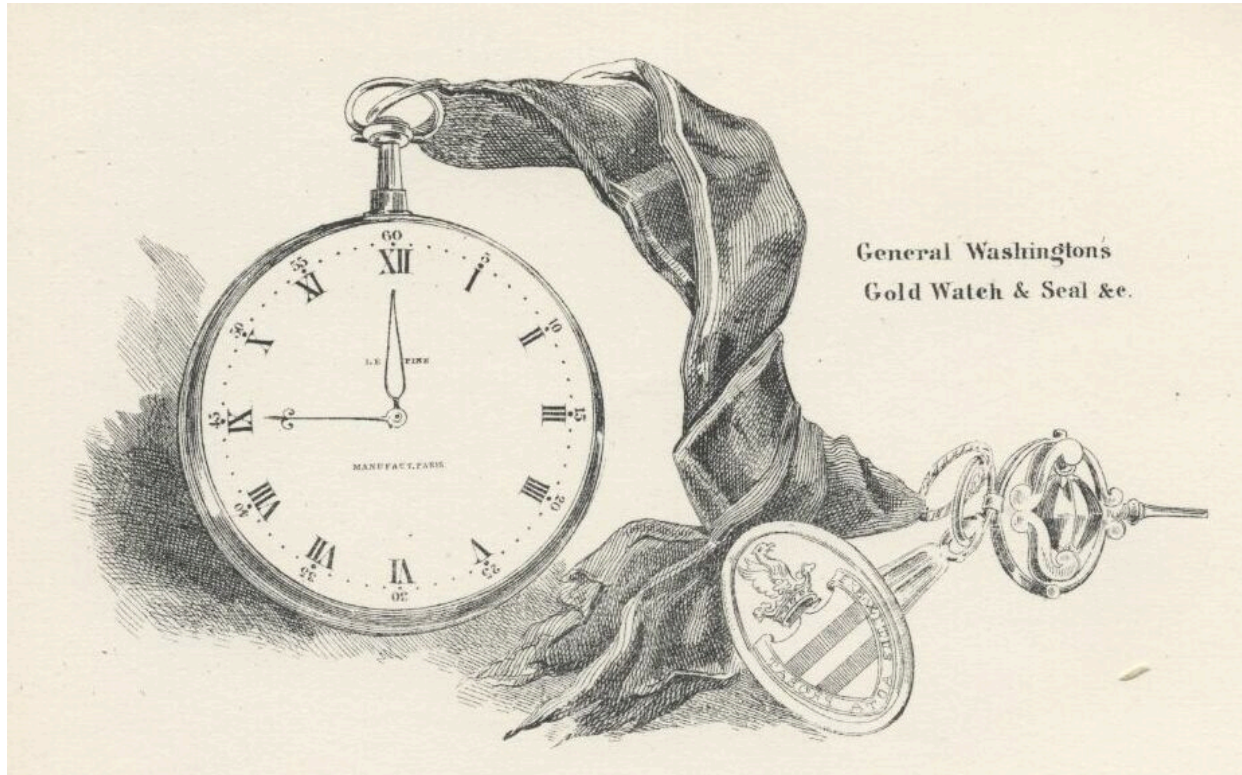
my home I shall
leave it by the 2. P.M.
line of I'm afraid
and if you will
permit me, to the
hospitality of my
kind friend Mr.
Peters for the
night at Helton

Very faithfully
Yours friend
G. H. Kane?

Geo. W. Childs
Delaware

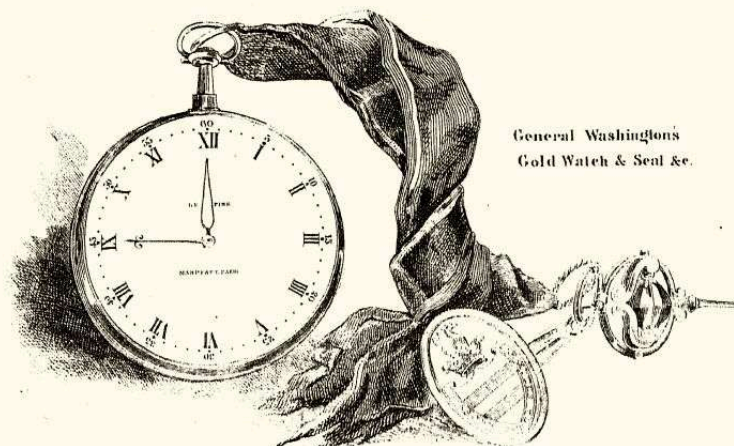
N. Y.
Sep. 23 86

Enlarge



General Washington's
Gold Watch & Seal &c.

Enlarge



General Washington's
Gold Watch & Seal &c.

Page of General Washington's Weather Diary

31

October 1799

19. Morning quite clear with a small breeze from the S.E. - Mer at 45. - a great circle round the Sun about Noon which cost 2 1/2 hours. & towards Night it began to cover much - Mer 55 at Night
20. Morning very heavy - Wind southerly & Mer at 54. - a strong Gale all day between the top of the Clouds - but the Sun shone Mer 62 at Night. - Doct. Mearns wife & three daughters - and young Dan. McCarty came to dinner & stayed all Night
21. Morning clear - wind southerly Mer at 60 - the forepart of the day variable - the latter part clear warm & pleasant - Mer at 64
22. Clear with the Wind at N.W. & Mer at 58. in the morning fresh Wind all day from the same quarter. - Mer 50 at Night Mr. Leston (British Minister) & Lady came to dinner - and so young Mr. McCarty. -
23. Morning clear & calm - Mer at 42. - Clear all day wind coming out from the N.W. but no fresh - Mer 49 at Night. - Mr. Herbert, Mr. & Mr. Mather - Mr. Gilman came to dinner - the last stayed all Night. -

General Washington Presents his Compliments to
Lieut. Groen and requests the favor of his
Company at Dinner tomorrow at 3 o'clock

Tobias Lear. -
Secretary to the President
of the United States.

Mr. R. Morris, presents his compliments
to The Honble Mr. Janifer
and requests the favour of his company to
dine on Thursday next 4 o'clock
Monday 12 Nov. 1781

Enlarge

*** END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK AMERICAN
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JOHN JAY SMITH.

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The Star-spangled banner.

O! say, can ye see by the dawn's early light,
What so proudly we hail'd by the twilight's last gleaming,
Whose bright stars & broad stripes, through the clouds of the fight,
O'er the ramparts we watch'd were so gallantly streaming?
And the rocket's red glare - the bomb bursting in air,
Gave proof through the night that our flag was still there,
O! say does that Star-spangled banner yet wave
O'er the land of the free & the home of the brave?

On that shore, dimly seen through the mists of the deep,
Where the foe's haughty host in dread silence reposes,
What is that which the breeze, o'er the towering steep,
As it fitfully blows, half-conceals, half-discloses?
Now it catches the gleam of the morning's first beam,
In full glory reflected, now shines on the stream,
'Tis the Star-spangled banner - O! long may it wave
O'er the land of the free & the home of the brave

And where is that host, that so vauntingly swore
That the havoc of war & the battle's confusion
A home & a country should leave us no more?
Their blood has wash'd out their foul footsteps' pollution
No refuge could save the hireling & slave
From the terror of flight or the gloom of the grave
And the star-spangled banner in triumph doth wave
O'er the land of the free & the home of the brave.

O! thus be it ever when freemen shall stand
Between their lov'd homes & the war's desolation
Blest with vict'ry & peace, may the heav'n rescued land
Praise the power that hath made & preserved us a nation
Then conquer we must - when our cause it is just,
And this be our motto - In God is our trust -
And the star-spangled banner in triumph shall wave
O'er the land of the free and the home of the brave.

Washington
Oct 21 1840

T. J. Key

[back](#)

Home, Sweet Home!

Pl. LVI

'Mid pleasures and palaces though we may roam,
Be it ever so humble, there's no place like Home,
A charm from the sky, seems to hallow us there
Which, seek through the world, is ne'er met with elsewhere!

Home, home! Sweet, sweet Home!
There's no place like Home!
There's no place like Home!

11.

An exile from Home, splendour dazzles in vain!
Oh, give me my lowly thatch'd cottage again!
The birds singing gaily, that came at my call—
Give me them — with the peace of mind dearer than all!

Home, home! Sweet, sweet Home!
There's no place like Home!
There's no place like Home!

John Howard Payne.

Washington City, Sept. 13. 1841.

My dear Sir,

* * * * *

At present however
I see no possible chance
of being able to work
in any way, and the
unpleasant letters
that crowd around
me must well speak
an able man.

I leave in
a fortnight probably,
for Europe as the
sort of last resource
to catch my last
breath. The book
press as at 4 - has
been my coffin

M^r. Formell's
house is at present

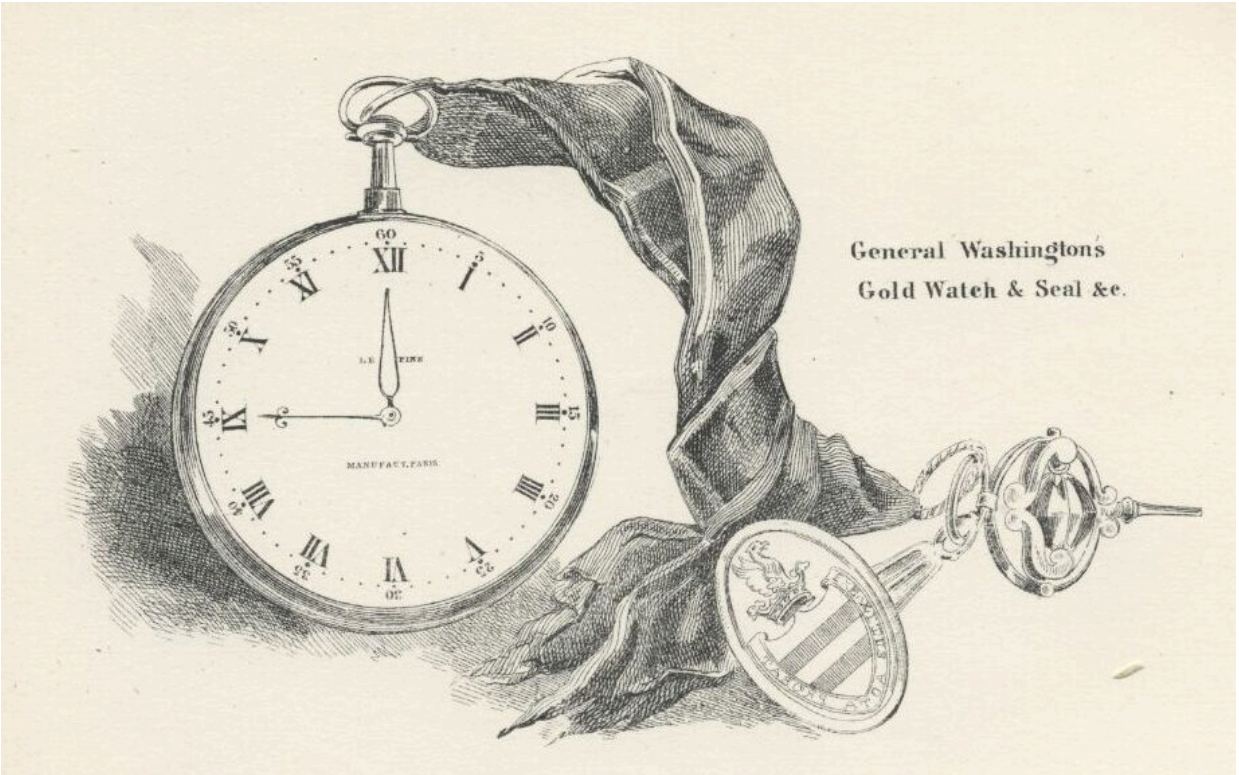
my home I shall
leave it by the 2. P.M.
line of I'm afraid
and if you will
permit me, to the
hospitality of my
kind friend Mr.
Peters for the
night at Helton

Very faithfully
Yours friend
G. H. Kane?

Geo. W. Childs
Delaware

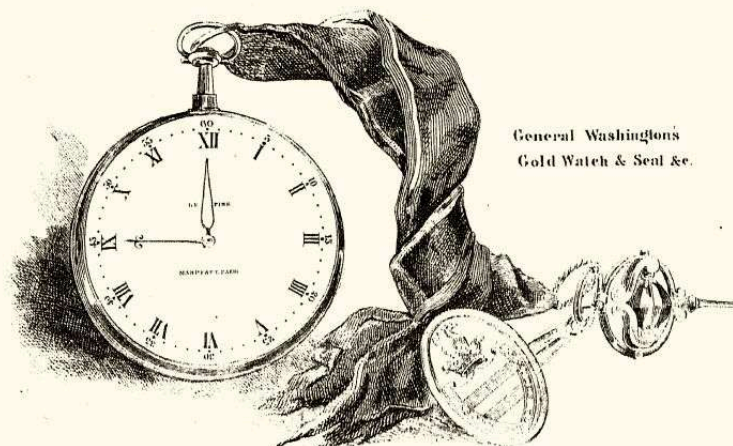
N. Y.
Sep. 23 86

[back](#)



General Washington's
Gold Watch & Seal &c.

[back](#)



General Washington's
Gold Watch & Seal &c.

Page of General Washington's Weather Diary

31

October 1799

19. Morning quite clear with a small breeze from the S.E. - Mer at 45. - a great circle round the Sun about Noon which cost 2 1/2 hours. & towards Night it began to cover much - Mer 55 at Night
20. Morning very heavy - Wind southerly & Mer at 54. - a strong Gale all day between the top of the Clouds - but the Sun shone Mer 62 at Night. - Doct. Mearns wife & three daughters - and young Dan. McCarty came to dinner & stayed all Night
21. Morning clear - wind southerly Mer at 60 - the forepart of the day variable - the latter part clear warm & pleasant - Mer at 64
22. Clear with the Wind at N.W. & Mer at 58. in the morning fresh Wind all day from the same quarter. - Mer 50 at Night Mr. Weston (British Minister) & Lady came to dinner - and so young Mr. McCarty. -
23. Morning clear & calm - Mer at 42. - Clear all day wind coming out from the N.W. but no fresh - Mer 49 at Night. - Mr. Herbert, Mr. & Mr. Mather - Mr. Gilman came to dinner - the last stayed all Night. -

General Washington Presents his Compliments to
Lieut. Groen and requests the favor of his
Company at Dinner tomorrow at 3 o'clock

Tobias Lear. -
Secretary to the President
of the United States.

Mr. R. Morris, presents his compliments
to The Honble Mr. Janifer
and requests the favour of his company to
dine on Thursday next 4 o'clock
Monday 12 Nov. 1781

[back](#)